UniRent Product Plan

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Overview and scope

UniRent is a mobile app (Android and iOS) for one university. Verified students lend, rent, buy and sell physical goods with each other. The app records every request, handover, payment and review, and turns them into a public trust score.

This plan covers features, rules and UI/UX flow only. Implementation choices come in a later revision.

The four connected systems from the PPT, as now scoped:

1. **Campus marketplace:** listings for rent or sale, search with live suggestions, saved searches.
2. **Trust and reputation:** blind two-sided reviews, separate lender and renter ratings, public trust badges that drive search ranking.
3. **Rental and asset lifecycle:** owner-approved bookings, in-person handovers with photos and OTP, return inspection, and an asset history that follows the item across owners.
4. **FinPay:** UPI through Razorpay or cash marked as paid, an append-only ledger of every payment, and reconciliation against Razorpay records.

Changes from the PPT. The team should update the deck to match.

Item in PPT	Status in this plan
Share transactions	Dropped. Only lend/rent and sell/buy.
Wanted requests	Dropped. Replaced by search with auto-suggestions.
Hostel/campus discovery	Dropped.
Event-ticket resale	Dropped.
Protected deposits, holds, partial deposit release	Dropped. No deposits; rent only. Hostel and room details give owners and moderators a way to follow up instead.
Trust shapes visibility and terms	Trust affects search ranking only.

Item in PPT	Status in this plan
Evidence-backed damage claims	Owner and renter agree on charges themselves; either can appeal to moderators.
Payouts and settlement	Rent goes straight to the owner's linked account through Razorpay, or as cash. No platform wallet, no platform fee.
React/Next.js web frontend and admin dashboards	Mobile app only. Admins and moderators use role-based screens in the same app.
In-app communication (not in PPT)	No chat between students; they call each other. A help chatbot answers questions and hands off to moderators (new).

Users, roles and permissions

There are three roles. Every student can act as lender, renter, seller and buyer from the same account.

Role	Who	Sign-in	Main abilities
Student	Any student with a college email	Microsoft OAuth, college domain only	List items, search, request, rent, buy, pay, review, appeal
Moderator	Accounts created by the admin	Email and password	Handle appeals, remove listings, suspend or ban users, apply trust penalties, view risk flags and residence details
Admin	One account	Email and password	Everything a moderator can do, plus create and deactivate moderators, reconciliation reports, platform metrics, manual refunds, audit log

Admins and moderators use the same mobile app as students. They see role-based screens instead of the student tabs.

Onboarding, accounts and profile

A student signs in with Microsoft, fills one short profile form, verifies their phone, and lands on Home. The residence details exist because there is no deposit. If an item isn't returned, the owner and moderators can follow up in person.

Onboarding steps:

1. Sign in with Microsoft. Only the university's email domain is accepted.
2. Fill the profile form:
    - profile photo
    - full name
    - phone number
    - roll number
    - department and year
    - residence type:
        - hostel students give hostel name and room number
        - day scholars give home address
3. Verify the phone number by OTP.
4. Accept the terms and community rules.
5. Allow push notifications. All alerts are push only.
6. Land on Home.

The college email is taken from the Microsoft sign-in, so the student doesn't type it.

Who sees what:

Information	Visible to
Name, profile photo, department and year, lender and renter trust badges, ratings, "New" badge, cancellation count	Everyone
Phone number	Everyone, since negotiation happens by phone call
Hostel and room, or home address	Moderators, admin, and the counterparty once a request is approved
College email, roll number	Moderators and admin only

Showing the profile photo, department and year to everyone is proposed.

Editing. Students can edit every profile detail at any time. The only exception is the college email, which comes from the Microsoft sign-in.

Account lifecycle:

- **Active:** normal use.
- **Suspended:** set by a moderator. The student can't list, request or transact, but can finish open handovers (proposed).
- **Banned:** set by a moderator. The student can't sign in.
- **Deactivated:** when the student graduates or leaves. Past transactions, reviews and asset history stay visible.

Later, not now: ID card verification. A student uploads their ID card, and if it matches their profile details, they get a Verified badge.

Listings and asset identity

A listing is either for rent or for sale, never both at once. Each listing points to a persistent asset record, and that record keeps the item's history across every rental and owner.

Listing fields:

Field	For rent	For sale	Notes
Title, category, photos, description	Yes	Yes	
Manufacture date, condition	Yes	Yes	Entered by the owner; not verified
Serial number	Yes	Yes	Entered by the owner. Hidden in public views; visible to the owner, moderators and admin
Price	Per hour, per day, or both	Fixed price	
Pickup point	Yes	Yes	Where handovers happen
Availability calendar	Yes	n/a	Approved bookings block their slots

The grace period and late fees are not listing fields. The admin sets them once for the whole platform, and every rent listing shows them.

Payout account. Before posting their first listing, an owner or seller must link a Razorpay account to receive UPI payments.

Editing rule. An owner can edit any field only while the item has no approved or active booking. Once a request is approved, that booking's price and terms are locked.

Listing states:

- **Active:** visible in search.
- **Paused:** hidden by the owner.
- **Sold:** after a completed sale.
- **Removed:** taken down by a moderator.

A rent listing returns to Active after each rental completes.

Asset identity. The asset record holds:

- the owner's details (manufacture date, serial number, condition)
- the photos from every pickup and return
- the number of past rentals
- any damage charges agreed or ruled

When an item is sold, the record and its full history transfer to the buyer, who can relist it. The details aren't verified. If an item doesn't match its description, the renter or buyer rates the owner low on "item matches description", and that lowers the owner's trust score.

Categories:

- Electronics
- Cameras and photography
- Cycles and mobility
- Books and study material
- Musical instruments
- Sports and fitness
- Hostel essentials
- Event and party gear
- Other

No items are prohibited yet.

Search and discovery

Search is the only way to find items. The search bar sits at the top of Home and suggests matching listings as the user types.

- **Home:** the search bar with live suggestions sits at the top. Below it (proposed layout):
  - category shortcuts
  - Recently listed
  - new matches for saved searches
- **Filters:** category, type (rent or buy), price range, available dates (rent only).
- **Sort:** by the owner's lender trust (default), newest, price low to high, or price high to low.
- **Saved searches:** a user can save a query and its filters. They get a push alert when a new matching listing is posted.
- **Listing detail page:**
  - photos and description
  - price, the platform late-fee rule and the grace period
  - availability calendar
  - asset history, with the serial number masked
  - an owner card showing name, photo, lender trust badge (or "New" badge), rating and cancellation count
  - a **Call** button for negotiation
  - a **Request to rent** or **Request to buy** button

If negotiation succeeds by phone, the owner updates the listed price before approving the request.

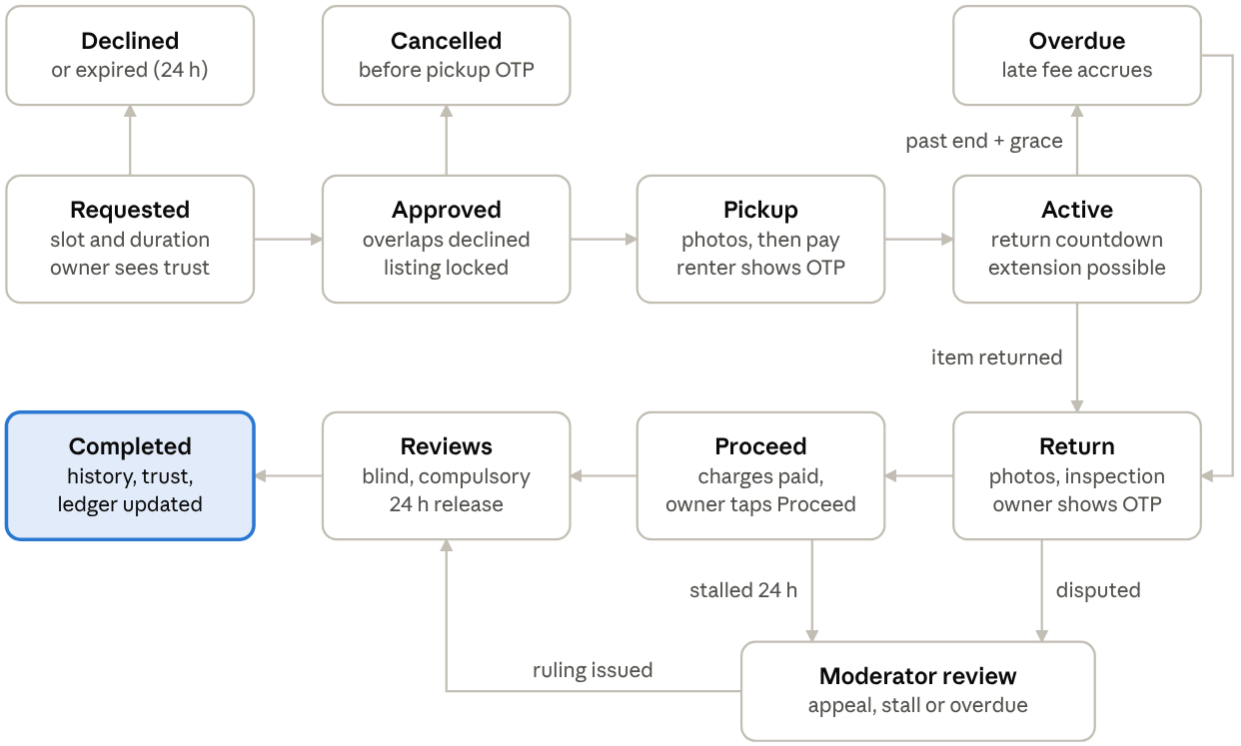
Rental lifecycle

Every rental passes through the same fixed sequence:

1. Request and owner approval
2. In-person pickup: photos, payment, OTP
3. Active period with a return timer
4. In-person return: photos, inspection, charges
5. Owner taps Proceed
6. Blind reviews

The flow follows Zoomcar's booking process, adapted for person-to-person handovers.

Rentals run one path; disputes and stalls go to moderators



rental states · 8 main steps, 4 side paths

A booking can be cancelled only before the pickup OTP. An overdue rental still ends in a normal return. A dispute or a stalled Proceed goes to a moderator, and reviews follow the ruling.

Step by step:

1. **Request.** The renter picks a start and end date/time; the duration must be stated up front. They see the total rent, the platform late-fee rule and the grace period, then send the request. While it is pending:
   - the renter can withdraw it
   - a request the owner hasn't answered in 24 hours expires
2. **Owner decision.** The owner sees the renter's renter trust badge (or "New" badge), ratings and cancellation count, then approves or declines. When the owner approves:
   - overlapping pending requests are auto-declined
   - the listing locks for editing
   - each side's hostel and room (or address) is revealed to the other
3. **Before pickup.** Either side can cancel after approval, up until the pickup payment and OTP. The canceller must attach a note giving the reason, which is sent to the other side. The other side reads the reason, then rates the canceller. See Cancellations.
4. **Pickup.** The two meet at the pickup point and complete these steps in order:

   a. Both upload pickup photos of the item.
   b. The renter chooses UPI or cash. UPI is paid through Razorpay in the app. Cash is handed over in person, and the owner marks it as paid.
   c. The renter shows the OTP and the owner enters it.

   The rental is now Active.
5. **Active.**
   - Both see a countdown to the return time.
   - The renter can request an extension, which the owner approves or declines. Extra time costs the listing rate. It is paid by UPI in the app when the owner approves, or in cash at return.
   - Both can call each other from the booking screen.
6. **Overdue.** Once the end time plus the grace period passes, a base late fee is charged, then a percentage of the booking's rent is added for every further hour. For a ₹50 rental, that could be ₹10 plus 2% (₹1) an hour, with the amounts set by the admin. The renter's trust drops further the longer the item is late.
   - Both get hourly push alerts.
   - One hour into overdue, the owner can escalate to moderators. Before that, they can reach moderators through the help chatbot.
   - The rental still ends with a normal return.
7. **Return.** The two meet and complete these steps in order:
   a. The renter uploads return photos.
   b. The owner inspects the item and uploads their own photos.
   c. The owner shows the OTP and the renter enters it, confirming the item is back.
   d. If there is damage, the two negotiate. The owner records the agreed charge, or either side raises an appeal.
   e. The renter pays any late fee and any agreed damage charge.
   f. The owner taps **Proceed**.
8. **Reviews.** Both rate each other blind, and reviewing is compulsory. Ratings are revealed once both submit, and both return to Home.
9. **Completed.** Three things update:
   - the asset history
   - both trust scores
   - the ledger entries for the booking, which close

Time-outs:

- A pending request expires after 24 hours.

- If the owner hasn't tapped Proceed 24 hours after the return OTP, the booking escalates to moderators.
- If one side hasn't reviewed 24 hours after the other submitted, the waiting side is released.

Buy/sell lifecycle

A purchase mirrors a rental up to pickup and then ends. There is no active period, return or late fee.

1. **Request to buy.** The buyer sends a request from the listing. They can withdraw it while it is pending, and it expires if unanswered after 24 hours.
2. **Seller decision.** The seller approves or declines. On approval, other pending requests are auto-declined and the listing locks.
3. **Before handover.** Either side can cancel after approval, up until the handover payment and OTP. The canceller must attach a note, which the other side reads before rating them.
4. **Handover.** The two meet and complete these steps in order:
   a. Both upload photos.
   b. The buyer chooses UPI through Razorpay, or cash marked as paid by the seller.
   c. The buyer shows the OTP and the seller enters it.
5. **Transfer.** Ownership and the full asset history move to the buyer. The listing becomes Sold.
6. **Reviews.** Both review blind, and reviewing is compulsory, as in rentals.

Sales count under the existing ratings: the seller under lender rating, the buyer under renter rating. They also count toward the first 5 trades for the "New" badge.

A buyer can appeal to moderators after the sale, for example if the item doesn't match its description. The proposed window is 48 hours after handover.

Payments (FinPay)

Money goes straight to the owner, either through Razorpay to the owner's linked account or in cash. The platform holds no wallet and charges no fee. FinPay records every payment in an append-only ledger and reconciles that ledger against Razorpay.

Payment methods:

- **UPI through Razorpay:** test mode in development and staging, live Razorpay in production. The payment routes to the owner's linked account. Every owner and seller must link a Razorpay account before listing.

- **Cash:** the renter or buyer picks "Pay with cash" at the payment step and pays in person. The owner then marks it as paid, and the renter doesn't need to confirm.

What gets paid:

Payment	When	From → to	Amount set by
Rent	At pickup, before the OTP	Renter → owner	Listing price × booked duration, locked at approval
Extension rent	On owner approval (UPI) or at return (cash)	Renter → owner	Listing price × extra duration
Late fee	At return, before Proceed	Renter → owner	Admin rule: base fee once the grace period ends, plus a percentage of the rent for each further hour
Damage charge	At return, before Proceed	Renter → owner	Agreed by both, or ruled by a moderator
Sale price	At handover, before the OTP	Buyer → seller	Listing price, locked at approval
Refund	After a moderator or admin ruling only	Owner → renter or buyer	The ruling

There are no refunds for early returns or cancellations. Cancellations happen before any payment.

Payment states:

- **Created:** the user opened the payment.
- **Pending:** waiting for Razorpay.
- **Captured:** paid.
- **Failed:** the user can retry.
- **Marked paid (cash):** confirmed by the owner.
- **Refunded:** after a ruling.

Guarantees users can see:

- Tapping Pay twice, or retrying after a network drop, never charges twice. The screen always shows one outcome.
- Every payment, cash mark and refund appears in both users' payment history, linked to the booking.

- Ledger entries are never edited. Corrections are new entries.

Reconciliation. The ledger is checked against Razorpay payment records and Razorpay settlement records for linked accounts. The admin sees any mismatch in a reconciliation report.

Trust score and reviews

Each user has two ratings and two trust scores, one as lender and one as renter. Each trust score runs from 0 to 100 and shows on a public badge. Trust affects search ranking and nothing else: there are no limits, deposits or perks tied to it.

Review parameters. Each review scores several parameters from 1 to 5 stars and includes a written comment. The weighted average of those scores, with equal weights for now, is that review's overall rating.

Rating	Given by	Parameters
Renter rating	Owner, after a rental	Item care, return punctuality, communication
Lender rating	Renter, after a rental	Item matches description, item condition, handover punctuality, communication
Renter rating (sale)	Seller	Handover punctuality, payment promptness, communication
Lender rating (sale)	Buyer	Item matches description, item condition, handover punctuality, communication
Cancellation rating	The side that didn't cancel, after reading the reason	One overall rating and a comment

Trust score inputs:

Input	Lender trust	Renter trust
Review ratings	Lender rating	Renter rating
On-time returns	n/a	Yes; lateness lowers the score more the later it is

Input	Lender trust	Renter trust
Damage charges against the user	n/a	Yes
Cancellations made	Yes	Yes
Account age	Yes	Yes

How trust is used:

- Search results rank by the owner's lender trust by default.
- Owners see the renter trust of each incoming request.
- Profiles show both badges and the public cancellation count.
- New users have no trust score until they complete 5 trades. Rentals, lendings, purchases and sales all count. Until then, only the "New" badge shows.
- When sorting by trust, a New owner's listings rank as if they had the campus median score (proposed).

Review rules:

- Reviews come only from completed or cancelled transactions, one per side per transaction.
- Every review has a star score for each parameter and a written comment.
- Reviews stay hidden until both sides submit, so neither can retaliate.
- Reviewing is compulsory before returning to Home. If the other side hasn't reviewed after 24 hours, the waiting side is released.
- Moderators can remove abusive reviews (proposed).

Cancellations, disputes and appeals

Cancellations cost nothing but are public. Disputes are settled between the two students first, and moderators step in only on appeal.

Cancellations:

- **Withdrawn and expired requests:** a requester can withdraw a pending request at any time, and a request with no answer expires after 24 hours. Neither counts as a cancellation (proposed).
- **Who can cancel, and when:** either side, after approval, until the pickup payment and OTP (rentals) or the handover payment and OTP (sales). There is no fee.
- **The note:** the canceller must attach a note giving the reason, which is sent to the other side.

- **The rating:** the other side reads the reason, then rates the canceller with one overall rating and a comment.
- **Visibility:** the cancellation count shows publicly on the profile and lowers trust.

Damage disputes:

1. At return, the owner inspects the item. If it's damaged, the owner and renter negotiate a charge face to face.
2. If they agree, the owner records the charge and the renter pays it before Proceed.
3. If they disagree, either side files an appeal from the booking. The pickup and return photos attach automatically, and either side can add notes and more photos.
4. A moderator reviews the appeal and rules. A ruling can include any of these:
    - a charge amount, or a refund
    - a trust penalty
    - removal of the listing
    - suspension or a ban
5. Both sides are notified, and the booking moves to reviews.

Buyers can appeal after a sale the same way. The admin can overrule any moderator ruling.

Other escalations to moderators:

- **Overdue items:** one hour into overdue, the owner can escalate from the booking. Before that, they can reach moderators through the help chatbot. Moderators can use the renter's residence details to follow up offline.
- **Stalled Proceed:** if the owner hasn't tapped Proceed 24 hours after the return OTP, the booking escalates automatically.

Notifications

All notifications are push notifications, and every one opens the related screen.

Event	Sent to
New rent or buy request	Owner or seller
Request approved, declined, auto-declined or expired	Requester
Request withdrawn	Owner or seller
Booking cancelled, with the canceller's note	The other side

Event	Sent to
Pickup reminder, 1 hour before the start time (proposed)	Both
Payment captured or cash marked paid	Both
Rental started	Both
Return reminder, 1 hour before the end time (proposed)	Renter
Overdue alert when overdue begins, then hourly	Renter and owner
Overdue escalation available (1 hour into overdue)	Owner
Extension requested, approved or declined	The other side
Damage charge recorded	Renter
Appeal filed, ruled, or ruling overruled by admin	Both sides; moderators on filing
Review waiting, reviews revealed	Both
Saved-search match	Searcher
Moderator replied in help chat	That user
Account suspended or banned	Affected user

Help chatbot

An in-app chatbot answers users' questions. When it can't help, it hands the conversation to a moderator. This is the only chat in the app; students still talk to each other by phone.

- **Where:** a Help entry on Profile and a Help button on every booking screen (proposed). Help opens a FAQs page and the chatbot.
- **What it answers:** only a fixed set of general questions about how UniRent works, such as booking steps, cancellations, the late-fee rule, payments, reviews and appeals. It does not look up the user's own bookings or payments.
- **Anything else:** the bot points the user to the FAQs, or offers "Talk to a moderator" when the question needs a person.
- **Moderator handoff:** the chat and its transcript go to the moderators' support inbox, and the moderator replies in the same chat.
- **Overdue items:** owners can use it to reach moderators at any time, including before the 1-hour escalation opens.

Moderator and admin functions

Moderators handle people and disputes. The single admin handles moderators, money records and platform health. Every action either role takes is written to the audit log.

Moderator screens:

- **Appeals queue:** booking timeline, photos, notes, a ruling form. Covers rentals and sales.
- **Support inbox:** chats handed off from the help chatbot, answered in the same chat.
- **Escalations:** overdue items (1 hour or more) and stalled Proceeds, with residence details for offline follow-up.
- **Listings:** review and remove.
- **Users:** view profile and history, suspend, ban, apply a trust penalty, remove abusive reviews.
- **Risk flags (proposed triggers):**
  - repeated overdue returns
  - many cancellations
  - many disputes
  - very low trust

Admin screens (in addition to all moderator screens):

- **Moderators:** create and deactivate accounts.
- **Late-fee rule:** set the grace period, the base late fee, and the hourly percentage of the booking's rent. Every rent listing shows the current rule.
- **Rulings:** overrule any moderator ruling.
- **Reconciliation report:** ledger vs Razorpay payments vs Razorpay settlements, with mismatches listed.
- **Manual refunds:** a recorded refund linked to a ruling.
- **Platform metrics:**
  - active listings
  - bookings by state
  - payment success rate
  - open disputes
  - overdue count
- **Audit log:** every moderator and admin action, read only.

UI/UX flow and screen map

Students move between four tabs: Home, Bookings, Listings and Profile. Every booking opens a Zoomcar-style booking screen. That screen shows a status timeline and the one action due next, such as "Upload pickup photos" or "Enter OTP". The tab structure is proposed.

Student screens:

Area	Screen	Purpose
Onboarding	Microsoft sign-in, profile form, phone OTP, terms acceptance, notification permission	Create a verified account
Home	Search bar with suggestions, category shortcuts, Recently listed, saved-search matches	Find items
Home	Results with filters and sort	Ranked by lender trust by default
Home	Listing detail	Photos, terms, late-fee rule, asset history, owner card, Call, Request
Home	Date/time picker and request summary	Pick a slot; see rent, late-fee rule and grace period; send
Home	Saved searches	Manage alerts
Bookings	My bookings (as renter/buyer)	Pending, upcoming, active, past, cancelled; withdraw a pending request
Bookings / Listings	Booking screen	Status timeline, counterparty card with Call, next action, Help
Bookings / Listings	Cancel with note	Reason sent to the other side, who then rates the canceller
Bookings / Listings	Pickup checklist	Photos → UPI or cash → OTP
Bookings	Active rental	Return countdown, extension request, overdue banner with live late fee
Bookings / Listings	Return checklist	Photos → inspection → OTP → charges → Proceed

Area	Screen	Purpose
Bookings / Listings	Appeal form	Notes, extra photos, auto-attached handover photos
Bookings / Listings	Review screen	Blind star ratings per parameter, written comment; waits for the other side
Listings	My listings	Active, paused, sold; add a listing
Listings	Add or edit listing	Asset details, pricing, grace period, pickup point, calendar
Listings	Incoming requests	Requester's trust or "New" badge, ratings, cancellations; approve or decline
Profile	My profile and edit profile	Badges, both ratings, cancellation count, reviews; edit any detail except college email
Profile	Payment history and payout account	Ledger view per booking; link Razorpay account (required before listing)
Profile	Public profile (others)	What other users see
Profile / Booking	Help chat	FAQs page, plus a chatbot for a fixed set of questions; anything else goes to the FAQs or a moderator

Renter journey:

1. Search → listing detail → Call the owner if negotiating.
2. Pick dates → review summary → send request. The booking screen shows "Waiting for owner".
3. Request approved → pickup reminder.
4. At pickup: photos → choose UPI or cash and pay → show OTP. Active screen with the countdown.
5. Optionally request an extension.
6. At return: photos → enter OTP → pay any charges → wait for Proceed.
7. Review → Home.

Owner journey:

1. Add a listing.
2. Incoming request push → check the renter's trust → approve.
3. At pickup: photos → mark cash paid if needed → enter OTP.
4. During the rental: approve or decline extensions; escalate if overdue.
5. At return: inspect and upload photos → show OTP → record any damage charge, or appeal → tap Proceed.
6. Review → Home.

Moderator and admin app: a separate tab set (Appeals, Support, Escalations, Users, Listings), plus Reports, Late-fee rule and Moderators for the admin.

Business rules summary and open items

The fixed numbers are below. The open items need a team decision before implementation planning starts.

Rule	Value
Platform fee	None
Deposit	None
Late fee	Set by the admin: a grace period, then a base fee (for example ₹10) plus a percentage of the rent for each further hour (for example 2%)
Pending request expiry	24 hours; the requester can withdraw sooner
Cancellation window	After approval, until the pickup or handover OTP; note required; no fee
Overdue escalation	Owner can escalate 1 hour into overdue; help chatbot any time
"New" badge	First 5 completed trades; no trust score shown until then
Rating scale	1–5 stars per parameter, equal weights, plus a written comment
Trust score scale	0–100
Review wait before release	24 hours
Stalled Proceed escalation	24 hours after the return OTP
Listing edits	Only while no booking is approved or active

Rule	Value
Payout account	Razorpay account linked before the first listing
Moderator rulings	Admin can overrule

Open items:

- [ ] Reminder timings: confirm 1 hour before pickup, 1 hour before return, and hourly while overdue.
- [ ] Sale appeal window: confirm 48 hours after handover.
- [ ] FAQ list: write the fixed set of questions the chatbot answers.